

SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE / REQUEST FOR INFORMATION (RFI)

Enterprise Commissary Operations – Federal Bureau of Prisons

Notice Type: Sources Sought / Market Research

NAICS Code: 445110 – Supermarkets and Other Grocery Retailers (except Convenience Retailers)

PSC Code: S216 – Housekeeping – Facilities Operation Support

1. Description

This Sources Sought Notice / Request for Information (RFI) is issued solely for market research purposes in accordance with FAR Part 10. It does not constitute a solicitation and does not commit the Government to issue a solicitation or award a contract. Responses will not be considered proposals and will not form the basis for award.

The Federal Bureau of Prisons (BOP) is seeking information from qualified vendors capable of providing enterprise-wide commissary operations across all Bureau of Prisons-managed institutions nationwide.

The BOP operates approximately 122 institutions nationwide.

Certain locations such as Federal Correctional Complexes (FCCs) consist of multiple institutions within a shared geographic area. While infrastructure may be co-located, vendors shall assume operational requirements at the individual institution level.

For purposes of this RFI, vendors shall assume commissary operations at all Bureau of Prisons-managed institutions.

Facilities may include, but are not limited to:

- Federal Correctional Complexes (FCCs)
- Federal Correctional Institutions (FCIs)
- Federal Detention Centers (FDCs)
- Federal Prison Camps (FPCs), including satellite camps
- Federal Medical Centers (FMCs)
- Medical Center for Federal Prisoners (MCFP)
- Federal Transfer Centers (FTCs)
- Metropolitan Correctional Centers (MCCs)
- Metropolitan Detention Centers (MDCs)
- United States Penitentiaries (USPs)

Facility types vary by mission, population, medical capability, and security level, which may impact commissary operations, logistics, product assortment, and distribution models.

The population supported is estimated at approximately 140,000 inmates within Bureau of Prisons-managed institutions.

Operations are expected to span institutions nationwide across multiple geographic regions.

For purposes of this RFI, “enterprise-wide” refers to coordinated commissary operations across all Bureau of Prisons-managed institutions nationwide, whether performed under a single contract or multiple regional contracts.

2. Scope of Services (Draft – For Information Purposes)

The Contractor shall be responsible for full commissary operations, which may include product sourcing, procurement, inventory management, order fulfillment, distribution, and overall program management.

Inmate labor will be utilized for commissary operations under the supervision, direction, and control of Government personnel. Vendors should describe their approach to operating within a Government-supervised labor environment, including coordination with Government staff, quality assurance, and methods for maintaining operational efficiency.

The Contractor shall provide management, technical oversight, quality assurance, and coordination with Government personnel.

System Environment (Trust Fund / Commissary Systems)

The Government currently utilizes the Trust Fund Accounting and Commissary System (TRUFACS) to support inmate trust fund and commissary operations.

Vendors shall describe their proposed approach to system utilization, including:

- Use of existing Government systems (e.g., TRUFACS)
- Hybrid approaches (leveraging both Government and contractor systems)
- Alternative contractor-provided systems

For any approach that does not fully rely on TRUFACS, vendors shall address:

- Data integrity and reconciliation with Government financial records
- Security and compliance considerations
- Reporting and auditability
- Transition requirements and implementation timeline
- Integration or interface requirements (if any)

The Government is not committing to system replacement or modification at this time; however, information provided will be used to assess feasibility, risks, and potential benefits of alternative approaches.

Commissary operations are primarily supported through inmate purchases. Vendors should describe pricing strategies, product sourcing approaches, and methods for managing affordability, product availability, and operational sustainability.

Contractor personnel must meet institutional access and background investigation requirements, which may be extensive and may impact staffing timelines, onboarding, and workforce availability. All operations shall comply with applicable security requirements within correctional environments.

Core Requirements

- Product sourcing and procurement (food, personal hygiene, apparel, electronics, and other approved items)
- Inventory management, demand forecasting, and replenishment
- Order processing (manual and/or electronic ordering systems)
- Packaging, fulfillment, and distribution to institutions

- Financial management and reconciliation aligned with Government financial records and systems.
- Order accuracy, discrepancy resolution, and coordination with Government personnel for issue resolution (e.g., missing items, damaged goods, or order errors)

Operational Considerations

- Centralized, regional, or hybrid distribution models
- Secure packaging and contraband prevention measures
- Loss prevention and shrinkage mitigation strategies
- Integration with existing institutional processes and systems

Inventory Ownership (Key Assumption Area)

Vendors should clearly identify assumptions regarding inventory ownership (Government-owned, contractor-owned, or hybrid), as this will significantly impact pricing, risk allocation, and financial structure.

Data Reporting and Visibility (Draft – For Information Purposes)

The Contractor shall provide routine operational and financial reporting to support Government oversight and performance monitoring.

Reporting is intended to enhance operational and financial visibility while operating within existing Government system constraints.

The Government does not currently anticipate system integration, modification, or replacement; however, vendors may propose alternative approaches for consideration, with associated risks, requirements, and benefits clearly identified.

Vendors are requested to describe their capability to provide the following data elements on a recurring basis (e.g., weekly or monthly):

- Total sales and revenue by institution
- Sales by major product category (e.g., food, hygiene, electronics, apparel)
- Average inmate spend (weekly and/or monthly)
- Participation rates (percentage of inmate population making purchases)
- Inventory levels and stock-out rates
- Order fulfillment metrics (e.g., accuracy, timeliness)
- Loss/shrinkage estimates and trends

Reporting should be deliverable via standard formats (e.g., spreadsheets, dashboards, or secure file transfer). Solutions should minimize reliance on direct integration with Government systems; however, vendors may propose limited or optional integration approaches where beneficial, with associated requirements and risk clearly identified.

Enterprise Responsibility

The Contractor is responsible for providing scalable, enterprise-level operational capability aligned with Government requirements and constraints.

Note: The Government retains full custody, control, and security responsibility. Contractor personnel shall have no custodial or disciplinary authority over inmates.

3. Purpose

- Identify capable sources with large-scale retail, commissary, or e-commerce experience
- Assess capability to operate in secure correctional environments
- Inform acquisition strategy (national vs. regional, single vs. multiple awards)
- Understand pricing models and financial structures

4. Requested Information

Company Information

- Legal name, UEI number, and business size status
- Socioeconomic status (if applicable)

Relevant Experience (Past 5 Years)

Demonstrate experience with:

- Large-scale retail, commissary, or e-commerce operations
- Multi-site or distributed operations
- Operations in controlled or secure environments (preferred)

Capability

- Ability to support nationwide or regional operations
- Supply chain, warehousing, and distribution approach
- High-volume order fulfillment capability
- Approach to contraband prevention, secure packaging, and loss mitigation
- Technology platforms for ordering, tracking, and reporting
- Ability to collect, aggregate, and report operational and financial data independently or in conjunction with Government systems (e.g., TRUFACS), while ensuring accuracy and consistency with official records

Operational Approach (Optional but Encouraged)

- Proposed commissary operating model (centralized, regional, or hybrid)
- Order fulfillment and distribution approach
- Integration with institutional processes
- Use of inmate labor (as described above)
- Approach to scaling across multiple institutions and geographic regions
- Approach to generating and validating reports using contractor-managed processes aligned with Government financial data

5. Cost / Pricing (ROM)

Vendors shall base Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM) estimates on full coverage of all Bureau of Prisons-managed institutions (approximately 122 institutions), unless otherwise stated.

Provide high-level, non-binding ROM estimates with clearly stated assumptions to support Government planning and comparative analysis.

The Government may normalize responses to account for differences in assumptions to enable comparative analysis.

Pricing Model

- Markup-based retail pricing
- Revenue-sharing model
- Fixed fee / management fee
- Hybrid approaches

Standardized Pricing Metrics (Required)

- Average inmate spend (weekly or monthly)
- Markup percentage by major product category
- Estimated annual gross sales

Estimated Financials

- Estimated annual gross revenue
- Estimated operating costs
- Estimated net revenue or profit (if applicable)

Key Assumptions

- Inmate participation rates
- Average spend per inmate
- Product mix and category distribution
- Supply chain and distribution model
- Use of inmate labor under supervision of Government personnel
- Technology and reporting approach
- Inventory ownership model
- Proposed system approach (TRUFACS, hybrid, or alternative platform)

Cost Drivers

- Procurement and supplier pricing
- Distribution and logistics
- Loss prevention / shrinkage
- Security requirements
- Technology and reporting systems
- Facility-level variability

Optional (Encouraged)

- Sensitivity analysis (e.g., changes in participation or spend)
- Opportunities for cost savings or revenue optimization

6. Industry Feedback

- Best practices for large-scale commissary operations in correctional environments
- Contraband prevention, shrinkage, and secure distribution risks and mitigation strategies
- Challenges with supply chain, demand variability, and multi-site operations
- Impacts of staffing constraints (including background investigations)
- Recommended geographic structuring (national vs. regional) and rationale
- Scalability, surge capability, and transition planning
- Recommended reporting practices to improve visibility without modifying Government systems

7. Submission Instructions

Responses are due no later than 12:00pm CDT May 14, 2026.

Submit via email to: BOP-ADM-MarketResearchResponse@bop.gov

Subject Line: Sources Sought / RFI Response – BOP Enterprise Commissary Operations

Limit responses to 10–15 pages or fewer (excluding attachments). Only high-level ROM estimates and assumptions are requested at this time.

8. Disclaimer

This notice is for market research and planning purposes only. It does not obligate the Government to award a contract or reimburse any costs. Cost estimates are non-binding.

9. Reference Information

General information on BOP institutions: <https://www.bop.gov>